

Reflection Log for Car Payment

How did you approach understanding the challenge?

I broke the problem into smaller pieces and started with the declarations and opening the scanner. Then I knew I would ask the user for the principal, interest rate, and number of monthly payments. I knew I had to plug those numbers into the textbook formula.

Were there any parts of the problem you found confusing at first? If so, how did you resolve that confusion?

I wondered how I would write the whole formula in text form. I tried myself, and I did most of it; however, I did not know how to handle the negative power. I looked it up.

Did you create a plan or break the problem into smaller steps before coding?

I broke the problem into smaller steps. It has made life easier.

How did you decide on the tools, data structures, or algorithms to use?

Even though the formula looks scary, all it is is getting numbers from the user and running them through the formula. So I needed a scanner, which is what we have been using for a month now.

Did you write the code in small pieces or attempt the entire solution at once?

I broke it into smaller pieces to make sure I did not mess it up early.

How did you test your solution along the way to make sure it was working?

Every couple of lines of code, I tested it, usually when I was writing a new piece of code that was structurally different from the other lines.

What part of the problem was the most difficult for you?

I did not know how to put the formula in text. I thought Java could only do simpler math, but I was proven wrong.

How did you handle moments when you felt stuck or unsure of what to do next?

I usually ask AI (searching it up, with the AI Overview)

Was there anything you learned that you think will help you with future challenges?

I do not know what the future projects will look like, but I figured out how to put negative power into the code, and that may help.